

Hackles Club: Library Toolkit

The Hackles Kit

Trust your hackles. Pause · Check · Tell.

FIELD COPY

1



Lock It

PASSWORDS AND ACCOUNTS

2



Spot It

SCAMS AND FAKES

3



Share Smart

PRIVACY

4



Safe People

WHO TO TRUST

5



Kind and Well

KINDNESS AND BALANCE

6



Fix It

TELL, REPAIR, RECOVER

PLATE I. The six strands, hand-inked, in the order the lessons take them.

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[Logo: Hackles]

Trust your hackles. *Pause · Check · Tell*

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Status: DRAFT. [VERIFY] and [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM] flags must be cleared before publication.

No patron accounts, no child data, no devices. Hackles in the library runs on paper, cards, puppets and people.

01 The librarian's one page

What it is. Hackles Club is a games-first set of short programs that teach children to notice when something online feels off, and to tell a trusted adult: **Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell.** A library can run it as a story time, a weekly club, a summer program or a one-day Hackles Day. It needs no screens.

Why a library. Libraries are trusted places where children already come to ask questions. A librarian is one of the trusted adults on a child's Trusted Hand.

What you need

NEED	DETAIL
Two adults	Two screened adults at every session, per your library's child-safety policy [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]
Space	A story-time corner or a meeting room with a visible window or open door
Supplies	Under \$10 for a program (index cards, tape, pom-poms)
Materials	Print from this folder. Read-alouds come from the Games and Fun Pack, file 04.
Time	30 minutes for a story time, 45 to 60 for a club, 60 to 90 for Hackles Day

What you do not do

- You do not collect any information about a child. Use your library's normal registration only if you already need it, and keep it with the library.
- You do not use library accounts, library computers or any device in the sessions.
- You do not teach sextortion, grooming, trafficking, sexual content, threats or self-harm. If a family asks, thank them and refer them to the school counselor, the resources in the Disclosure and Incident Guide (kit/05_Teacher_Support/), or your library's safeguarding lead.
- You never promise a child secrecy. If a child tells you something about their safety, use the card in Start Here, Section 6, and follow your library's policy and the law [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM reporting duty where you live].

Choose a format

FORMAT	AGES	TIME	WHERE TO FIND IT
Story time (read-aloud and a quick game)	K-3 (5 to 9)	30 min	Track A and B, Section 3 below, each session's "Story-time version"
Weekly club	5-7, 8-11, 12-15	45 to 60 min, 6 weeks	Files 02, 03, 04

FORMAT	AGES	TIME	WHERE TO FIND IT
Summer program	5-15	8 sessions	Files 02, 03, 04
Family night	5-15 with adults	90 min	File 05
Hackles Day at the library	5-15	60 to 90 min	Section 5 below
Take-home passport	5-15	any time	Section 4 below

Your feedback. Count what you ran (sessions, head counts, take-home cards given) in the impact tally (file 12). Counts only.

02 Book display

Titles are left blank on purpose. The authors of this kit did not verify that any title is in print or in your collection, so the list below is a template. A librarian chooses titles, checks them against the catalog and the library's collection policy, and reads them before displaying them. [librarian to fill]

DISPLAY SIGN (PRINT FOR THE TABLE)

FIELD NOTE	No. 1
Trust your hackles. Something online feels odd? Hackles up! Pause. Check. Tell a trusted adult. Ask a librarian. We are one of your trusted adults. <i>A false alarm is fine. It is never your fault.</i>	

DISPLAY LIST TEMPLATE (FILL IN)

SECTION	WHAT TO LOOK FOR	TITLE	AUTHOR	CALL NUMBER	READ AND APPROVED BY
Staying safe online (ages 5-7)	Picture books on safe and kind behaviour with screens	[librarian to fill]			
Staying safe online (ages 8-11)	Chapter books and nonfiction on internet safety, privacy and scams	[librarian to fill]			
Staying safe online (ages 12-15)	Nonfiction and graphic books on privacy, scams and media literacy	[librarian to fill]			
Passwords, codes and puzzles	Cipher and code books for kids	[librarian to fill]			
Kindness and speaking up	Picture books and novels on being kind and standing up	[librarian to fill]			
Making mistakes and starting over	Picture books where a character makes a mistake and recovers	[librarian to fill]			
Who can help? Trusted adults	Books about helpers and asking for help	[librarian to fill]			
Fake or real?	Books on media literacy, how to check a source, how photos and stories can fool us	[librarian to fill]			
Calm and screen balance	Books about calming down, outdoor play and taking breaks	[librarian to fill]			

SUGGESTED CATALOG SEARCH TERMS

online safety for children; internet safety; computer security for children; privacy; passwords; ciphers and codes for children; kindness; bullying and cyberbullying (general); mistakes; helpers; media literacy; fake news; screen time. [VERIFY terms against your catalog's subject headings]

DISPLAY CHECKLIST

- ☐ Every book is in your collection and was read by a librarian.
- ☐ Every book is age-appropriate under your collection policy.
- ☐ Books about sensitive topics (abuse, sexual content, threats) are shelved where your policy says, and are not part of the Club display.
- ☐ The sign is posted.
- ☐ The display includes Hackles Club cards to take.

03 Programming ideas

A. STORY TIME (30 MINUTES, AGES 5 TO 9)

MIN	WHAT
3	Welcome, two promises, Hackles Chant
12	Read-aloud from the Games and Fun Pack (file 04): Read-Aloud 1 "Hackle's Tuft Pops Up", Read-Aloud 2 "Latch and the Silly Words", Read-Aloud 3 "Pip Picks a Shell", Read-Aloud 4 "Fixit and the Oops Button". Ages 8 to 9: Read-Aloud 5 "The Treasure That Wasn't", Read-Aloud 6 "Mateo's Passphrase Puzzle", Read-Aloud 8 "Sam's Whoops Day".
5	Talk: two or three questions from the "Talk about it" section of the story
5	A quick game: Pause Palm Freeze, Share or Shell, or a Quick Catch of 6 cards
3	Ember's Warm Breath
2	Take-home card and a library stamp

EACH SESSION PAGE IN Track A and Track B has its own story-time version.

Six-week story-time series: Hackles Up, Latch, Peeper, Pip, Fixit, Kind Clicks.

B. AFTER-SCHOOL OR WEEKLY CLUB (45 TO 60 MINUTES)

Run a track from file 02, 03 or 04.

C. SUMMER READING TIE-IN

Add a Hackles Passport (Section 4) to your summer reading program as a second page. Children earn a stamp for each Hackles session they attend, or for each activity done at home with a family adult. No child's name goes on any list.

D. DROP-IN GAMES TABLE

Keep a table with a Quick Catch (8 cards) and a Pause Palm sign. Any child or family can stop and play for 10 minutes. A librarian runs it. Rotate through Sets A, B and C.

E. ESCAPE-THE-ROOM AFTERNOON

Run the Quiet Door mission (Track B Session 6 or the Track C Account Vault) in a meeting room, with teams of 3 to 5 and a Door Keeper. Tape the Door on the floor. Allow 45 minutes.

F. TEENS AS HELPERS

Teens aged 14 and up may help at younger sessions if your policy allows: hand out cards, read card backs, cheer. A teen never counts as one of the two adults and is never alone with a younger child [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM].

G. FAMILY NIGHT

Follow file 05. A library meeting room is ideal.

H. A "ASK A LIBRARIAN" MOMENT

End each program with: "If you ever have a question about something online, a librarian is a person you can ask." Make sure your staff know how to respond: calm, kind, no judgment, and no investigation. Use the Start Here card.

I. COMMUNITY PARTNERS

If you invite a guest (a local police officer, a school counselor), they follow your library's guest-speaker policy and the Hackles rules: no scary stories, no real cases, no sensitive topics in the Club. [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]

04 The take-home Hackles Passport

What it is. A small folded card that a child keeps. A librarian or leader stamps or initials a box when the child does the activity, in the library or at home with a family adult. The library keeps no record.

How to make it. Print the passport page on card stock, cut on the line, fold in half. Stamp with any stamp, a sticker or a pen mark.

PASSPORT (PRINT, CUT AND FOLD)

FIELD NOTE	No. 2
Hackles Passport <i>Trust your hackles. Pause · Check · Tell</i> This passport belongs to: _____ (a made-up name is fine) Stamp a box when you do the activity. Skill Ages 5-7 Ages 8-11 Ages 12-15 Stamp --- --- --- --- --- --- 1 Hackles Up! Do the Hackles Up move Name two "hackles up" feelings Name three cues something is off [] 2 Pause Palm Show the Pause Palm Pause on cue three times Name your first five seconds [] 3 Peeper's Peek Sort 4 pop-up cards Name one SPOT clue Name one FLAGS clue and a second channel [] 4 Tell Wave Say "I need help with something online" Name three on your Help Ladder Say the Tell-3 script [] 5 Silly Password Say three silly words (not real) Build a four-word practice passphrase Say why one password per account matters [] 6 Share or Shell Sort 4 cards Sort 6 cards Name a permission an app does not need [] 7 Kind Click Say one kind thing Name the four upstander moves Practice Say It or Stand With [] 8 Oops Is Okay Say "I made an oops, I need help" Do the O.O.P.S. steps Order the Oops Path [] A false alarm is fine. It is never your fault. A librarian can be one of your trusted adults. <i>Not affiliated with any scouting or other youth organisation. © 2026 Competence Collective.</i>	

PASSPORT RULES

- A child can start any box.
- Anyone, including a family adult, can stamp.
- A completed passport earns a library certificate (file 13) or a sticker.
- Passports are theirs to keep. Nobody checks them against a list.
- If a child cannot read, a helper reads each line.

PASSPORT AT HOME

Add a line on the back: "Do the activity at home with a family adult. Initial the box. Bring it back."

05 Hackles Day at the library

Goal: A one-day, drop-in or timed event where children and families try four to six Hackles stations in the library.

Time: 60 to 90 minutes. **Ages:** 5 to 15, with adults.

Staff: at least 2 screened adults in the room at all times, plus one volunteer per station, plus a "door host".

Budget: under \$10 on top of paper.

STATIONS (CHOOSE FOUR TO SIX)

#	STATION	BASED ON	LEADER
1	Peeper's Pond (Spot the Fishy)	Set A, B and C Quick Catch	Volunteer
2	The Hackles Trail (a table-top Mini Trail)	Trail scenes TA, TB, TC	Volunteer
3	Storytime Tent	Read-Alouds 1 to 4	A librarian
4	Gifty's Puppet Corner	"No Thanks, Gifty" and R5, and a short puppet scene	Two adults (Gifty is always an adult voice)
5	Latch's Passphrase Studio	Word Bank cards and the dice demo	Volunteer
6	Ember's Calm Corner and Code Word Table	Warm Breath, family code word idea cards	Volunteer

Station cards are in the Hackles Day Event Plan (Games Pack, file 09) and in the Family Night Kit (file 05).

FLOOR PLAN

Put stations along the walls so every station is visible to the door host. Put the Calm Corner in the quietest corner. Keep a clear path. Hang the Hackles routine poster and the Help Ladder card by the door.

RUN OF SHOW (75 MINUTES)

MIN	WHAT
0 to 10	Welcome. Two promises, Hackles Chant, how stations work, "no photos" sign.
10 to 60	Stations. Children and families wander. Each visit is 8 to 10 minutes. Passport stamp at each station.
60 to 70	Closing circle. Chant, pledge, thank you.
70 to 75	Take-home cards and goodbye. Certificates for passport holders.

PLEDGE

"I will pause when my hackles are up. I will tell someone I trust. I know it is never my fault."

RULES FOR THE DAY

- **Two screened adults in the room at all times.**
- **No photos** unless your library's media policy and a family's written permission both cover it [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM].
- **No devices.** No library computers used.
- **No real accounts, passwords, names or incidents** at any station.
- **A counselor-like person.** Name the staff member who is the "if something comes up" person. Put the name on the leader card. If your library has a social worker or a safeguarding lead, ask them to be on call.
- **Pass is always fine.**
- **No child is required to perform.**

HACKLES DAY STAFF CHECKLIST

- ☐ Two screened adults confirmed for the whole event
- ☐ Safeguarding lead on call
- ☐ Stations staffed
- ☐ Passport and stamps ready
- ☐ Cards cut for each station
- ☐ "No photos" sign at the door
- ☐ Quiet space marked
- ☐ Take-home cards counted
- ☐ Impact tally ready (counts only)

AFTER THE EVENT

Fill in the impact tally (file 12). Write down what to change for next time. Do not note any child.

06 For library staff: if a child tells you something

PRINT THIS CARD AND keep it behind the desk. It is a short version of Start Here, Section 6.

- Stay calm. Keep your voice soft.
- Say: "Thank you for telling me. This is not your fault. You are not in trouble."
- Move to a place that is private for the child and visible to a colleague.
- Listen. "Tell me more." Do not ask "Why did you...?"
- Be honest: "I can't keep this a secret, because I need to get you help. I will tell you who I tell."
- Write down their exact words afterward.
- Tell your library's safeguarding lead the same day, or at once if the child is in danger. Report personally if the law requires it. [FILL IN local rule] [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]
- If a device holds pictures, do not look at, copy or forward them.
- If a child may hurt themselves, stay with them and call your emergency or crisis number.

Contacts: Safeguarding lead _____ Local child protection
line _____ Emergency _____ Crisis line _____